Ethics memo

Privacy in future vehicle location tracking

Right now, EcoCharge shows fictional information about the cars and doesn't know who drives the car or where the driver is going. If some other version of EcoCharge uses actual information about cars' locations, it will tell the information about the movement of the drivers and their private life.

ACM Principle 1.6 on privacy calls for gathering only necessary information, explaining the purposes for which it will be used, and ensuring that this information is not accessed by unauthorized parties. ACM Principle 1.2 on preventing harm also helps support thinking about the implications of monitoring on drivers.

One of our major mitigations would be restricting the collection and utilization of the location to only fleet management. We will show only the required amount of information that will serve the purpose, access to which will be restricted to only the authorized persons, and the location of data will not be collected outside the agreed upon time period. The drivers must be informed about all this.

We will have a short and justified retention time for the information collected and will give users the possibility to correct their information. These are some of the safeguards that we can put in place in case our tracking system is ever used in the future.

Sources

- ACM Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct, course-provided copy: Principle 1.6 Respect privacy (p. 4) and Principle 1.2 Avoid harm (p. 2).
- ICS432 Assignment 2 brief, Ethical Considerations (pp. 4-5). Current prototype reviewed in ICS432 Assignment-2-main.zip, especially fleet.js and index.html.